



Sharp 37" Aquos LC-37AF3M

One Great TV

LCD TVs just seem to be getting bigger: last month it was a Samsung 26-inch beauty, and this time, we received the 37-inch Sharp LC-37AF3M from their latest Aquos range. Setting up this one took no time at all—

motivation being the key—and all 26 kgs (stand included) were unpacked and hooked up in a jiffy! The finish on the panel isn't as good as that on the Samsung Bordeaux series we tested earlier; build quality is a little above average, though not outstanding.

With two Component connectors, an S-Video In, an AV-Out and even an HDMI (High Definition Media Interface), you have all the possible connectivity avenues. Thoughtfully, a headphone jack has also been provided, while the speakers are rated at 20W RMS. The high-res screen on the Aquos is suitable for high-definition content viewing. Vertically, the screen consists of 540 dots, exactly half the 1080i (1920 x 1080 interlaced HD) resolution specification, and three quarters of the 720p (1280 x 720 progressively scanned).

We set up this panel on our Xbox 360 first, for a round of *Project Gotham Racing* and *Dead or Alive 4*, and were in for a real joy-ride. The Aquos delivers smooth viewing with great colour reproduction and good wide-angle viewing. Next, we hooked up our DVD player and popped in one of our test DVDs. What followed was a sight for sore eyes! The screen delivers great colour and light contrast, making it ideal for home TV viewing. Although HD television is absent in India, you will notice the difference even with regular TV broadcasts. Just make sure you have a living room that's large enough to view this beauty from a distance of at least 15 feet, or you will notice pixelation, which is common to all LCDs when viewed from close.

At Rs 1,39,900, the Sharp Aquos is costly for a 37-inch display. The good news is that with prices expected to fall over the next few months, great LCD TVs like this one are about to get a whole lot cheaper.

Specifications

37" black TFT LCD, 960x540x3 dots, colour system: PAL / SECAM / NTSC 3.58 / NTSC 4.43 / PAL 60, TV: VHF/UHF/CATV (including hyperband), 99 auto-preset channels, input terminals: co-axial, 2x Component, S-Video, HDMI; output terminals: S-Video, 3.5 mm audio jack; operating voltage: 110 - 240 V 50 Hz, power consumption: 111 W, weight: 26 kg (with stand).

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Package contents	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Contact: Sharp India Limited
Phone: 022-55032884 / 55032885 E-mail: perspective@mumbai@vsnl.net
Web site: www.sharpiindialimited.com
Price: Rs 1,39,900

Kodak EasyShare P880

Wide-Angle Delight

The mighty 8MP Kodak EasyShare P880 boasts of a fantastic mix of features. The sensor apart, the P880 has a superb wide-angle 24-140 mm lens. This allows taking close-ups and zoom shoots equally well. Fitted with optics from Schneider-Kreuznach, it offers manual zoom as well as a mechanically-linked focus ring. The ergonomics is spot on. Holding the camera is a little difficult, though. The body is completely made of plastic, but the P880 exudes a sturdy feel.

The five-way joystick is just fantastic, and so is the mode dial—both of them can be easily operated via a simple flick of the thumb. The large 2.5-inch LCD is a crisp display, though the resolution could have been a little better. The 1700 mAH Li-ion battery lasts long enough for over 200 shots. The P880 comes with 32 MB of onboard memory, which can be expanded using the SD slot.

What's really special about the pseudo-SLR P880 is the sheer number of features Kodak has cramped in, most of which are traditionally found on SLRs. A live histogram is one such very useful feature. The ability to save files directly in TIFF and RAW gives the P880 an edge.

Apart from the Auto mode, the P880 comes with complete manual, aperture priority, shutter priority and preset scene modes. Macro and super macro modes allow you to shoot subjects as close as 5 cm away. Dedicated buttons for white balance, ISO, flash, and focus let you change these parameters easily.

Colour saturation is near perfect—a Kodak trait—no traces of any colour noise at ISO 50. Focusing was sharp; in low light conditions, the focusing seems to be searching, but the occurrence of this problem is rare enough to ignore. Close-ups were astounding—sharp focus and good depth. Flash performance couldn't be better, at least for a camera in this range. At Rs 26,999, the Kodak EasyShare P880 is definitely worth the money. But hang on—what the P880 lacks is an image stabiliser, and that leaves some

scope for looking at similarly-priced cameras from Panasonic, such as the FZ-30. For wide-angle shoots, the P880 is undeniably the best camera in its class.

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Contact: Kodak India Private Ltd
Phone: 022-66416300
E-mail: contactindia@kodak.com
Web site: www.kodak.co.in
Price: Rs 26,999

Specifications

8.0 megapixel, 24 mm - 140 mm, 5.8x optical zoom, 2.5" LCD, 32 MB internal memory, SD/MMC card slot, video capture: 640 x 480 at 30 fps, 320 x 240 at 30 fps